# GAILIUS PRANINSKAS

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**Placement Officer:** Matthias Doepke, M.Doepke@lse.ac.uk
**Placement Team:** Emma Taverner, Will McGeough, Paige Edwards, econ.facultysupport@lse.ac.uk

## EDUCATION

**PhD** **London School of Economics and Political Science, Economics** *2022 – 2027 (expected)*
Fields: Political Economy, Economic History, Public Economics

**MASc** **Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Data, Economics, Development Policy** *2020*

**BSc** **University of Amsterdam, Economics and Business** *2019*

## REFERENCES

**Tim Besley** T.Besley@lse.ac.uk
School Professor of Economics and Political Science, London School of Economics

**Jeremiah Dittmar** J.E.Dittmar@lse.ac.uk
Associate Professor of Economics, London School of Economics

**Noam Yuchtman** n.yuchtman@lse.ac.uk
Hayek Professor of Political Economy, London School of Economics

## JOB MARKET PAPER

*How Enfranchisement Led to Representation* (with Ellen Munroe) Draft, October 2026

How did enfranchisement make Parliament more representative of the population? Was it because poorer politicians were elected and advocated different policies, or because all politicians responded to new voters? We study Britain's democratisation, combining 17 million wealth-at-death records with biographies of Members of Parliament (MPs) to place politicians, their fathers and voters in the same wealth distribution from 1858 to 1990. The wealth gap between MPs' fathers and the population fell from 2,900 times in the 1860s to 7 in the 1980s. We estimate the effect of the enfranchisement Acts of 1867, 1884, 1918 and 1928 across cohorts of politicians and across constituencies. Poorer constituencies voted for the party that fielded poorer candidates, but the early Acts barely changed MPs' backgrounds or Parliament's attention to the poor. Enfranchisement brought MPs from poor backgrounds into Parliament only after 1900, once Labour and trade unions financed their candidacies. Analysing 5.9 million parliamentary speeches, we find that these MPs advocated for policies benefiting the poor, which Parliament then began to pass. MPs from rich backgrounds did not argue more for the poor when their own voters became poorer. Enfranchisement changed policy by changing who was elected.

## WORKING PAPERS

*Wealth and Political Dynasties* (with Ellen Munroe) Draft, November 2026

We show that whether political dynasties are harmful depends on what they pass on: economic or political capital. We merge the family trees of British MPs and other elites with the wealth-at-death records, and compare the sons of MPs with the sons of equally wealthy men who were not MPs. Over time, the advantage of a rich father has fallen while that of an MP father has risen. Using the timing of the father's death as a shock to inheritance, we show that the sons of rich non-politicians enter politics once their father's wealth passes to them, whereas the sons of MPs enter while their father is still alive. Political capital is rewarded by parties rather than voters. The sons of MPs are more likely to reach government, but win no more votes than other candidates and speak less once in office. The sons of the rich advocate for different policies, but are no more likely to reach government than other MPs. Inheritance taxation did not reduce the presence of dynasties, suggesting that policies aimed at inherited wealth do little to open political office when the advantage being passed on is political.

*Privatising Common Property: Evidence from the Welsh Enclosures* (with Ellen Munroe). Draft on request
Economists stress that well-defined private property rights matter for efficiency and development, yet little is known about what happens when common land is privatised. We study the Welsh Parliamentary Enclosures: 227 Acts of Parliament, 1760–1936, that put communally owned or managed land under a single owner. We digitise every Welsh enclosure and link them to parish censuses, grain prices and land-ownership records. Contrary to common historical accounts, enclosure did not reduce population or change farming occupations, and it was not associated with grain prices. Enclosed parishes ended up with significantly lower land values and less concentrated land ownership than unenclosed parishes. We argue that enclosure created many fragmented holdings, which led to hold-up and other contracting problems.

## WORK IN PROGRESS

*Why Become a Politician? Pecuniary Incentives and Selection* (with Ellen Munroe)
Do people enter politics because office is lucrative or because they want to change policy? We observe the wealth at death of winning and losing candidates since 1832, across two reforms to the rewards and costs of office: the introduction of MPs' salaries in 1911 and the parties' assumption of campaign costs after 1949. Using a Roy model of political entry, we find that office paid only for Conservatives after 1945. For everyone else, politics was not lucrative, and who entered after the reforms is consistent with candidates seeking to change policy.

*Wealth Is Health? Life Expectancy and Public Goods* (with Ellen Munroe)
We ask whether the rise in life expectancy since the mid-nineteenth century came from economic growth or from public health, and who gained from each. In 1858, within the top 20% of the wealth distribution, each additional wealth percentile was associated with 4.8 more months of life. By 1940 this gradient had largely disappeared, even though wealth inequality remained extreme, and people at any given level of wealth lived over a decade longer. This convergence came through reductions in child mortality from diseases of crowding and poor sanitation. We ask which public investments closed the gap, and where the demand for these goods came from. We find that the towns that built public water and sewerage were the richest, not those where most poor people had the vote.

*A Century of Women in Power? Household Composition and Women's Representation*
Why did women's representation in parliaments rise only decades after women could vote? I argue that representation followed a change in household composition. As long as most women lived in their fathers' or husbands' households, they voted as their households did. Women who lived on their own voted independently. In eight Western European countries, young unmarried women moved to the left from the 1980s, and parties of the left then fielded more women candidates. Parties of the left reached 20 percent women ten to twenty years before parties of the right, after young women's votes had changed. In most countries, party and national quotas were adopted after this change in women's votes. I study the mechanism in more detail in Britain, using Gallup polls from 1955 to 1991. Young women living on their own moved to the left first, in the 1970s, and all young unmarried women followed by the mid-1980s. Married women did not change who they voted for. Women voters then began to prefer women candidates, and parties responded by fielding more women.

## OTHER PUBLICATIONS

*RCTs & Human Uplift Studies: Methodological Challenges and Practical Solutions for Frontier AI Evaluation* (with Patricia Paskov, Kevin Wei, Shen Hong, Dan Bateyko, Xavier Roberts-Gaal, Carson Ezell, Valerie Chen, Umang Bhatt and Ella Guest). *Proceedings of the AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society*, 9(3), 2036–2052, 2026.

## FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

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| LSE Class Teacher Award | *2026* |
| LSE Summer School Class Teacher Award | *2024* |
| ESRC DTP PhD Fellowship | *2022 – 2026* |
| Marius Jakulis Jason Knowledge Grant, Kitas 100 and Talentai Lietuvai Study Grants | *2020* |

## RESEARCH GRANTS

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| Michio Morishima Fund | *2024* |
| STICERD Small Grant | *2024* |
| Hayek Programme Grant | *2023* |

## PRESENTATIONS

**2026** 2nd Warwick-LSE Political Economy PhD Conference; HYRCE, Liège; KIZ Political Economy Workshop; Linnaeus Inequality Summit; LSE Seminar for Political Economy and Economic History (SPEECH)

**2025** Danish Historical Political Economy Workshop; Royal Economic Society Annual Conference; 14th Annual Lithuanian Conference on Economic Research; Warwick-LSE Political Economy PhD Conference; Oxford Political Economy Work in Progress; LSE Political Science Political Economy Work in Progress; SPEECH

**2024** LSE Workshop on Institutions and Political Economy; SPEECH

## ACADEMIC SERVICE

SPEECH Seminar (Political Economy and Economic History), **Co-Founder** — *2023 – Present*
Warwick-LSE PhD Political Economy Conference, **Co-Founder** — *2024 – Present*
PhD Applicant Mentoring Programme, LSE, Coordinator — *2023 – 2025*
PhD Applicant Mentoring Programme, LSE, Mentor — *2022 – Present*
PhD Student Representative, LSE — *2022 – 2024*
Referee: Economica — *2024 – Present*

## TEACHING

**London School of Economics** — Teaching evaluation summary
EC307 – Development Economics — *2025 – Present*
EC2B5 – Macroeconomics II — *2026*
EC260 – The Political Economy of Public Policy — *2024 – 2026*
EC317 – Labour Economics — *2024 – 2026*
EC101 – Introductory Microeconomics — *2024*
EC2C1 – Econometrics II — *2024*
FM250 – Finance — *2024 – 2025*
EC400 – Probability and Statistics — *2023 – 2026*
EC1A3 – Microeconomics I — *2023*

**University of Amsterdam**
Economics of Markets and Organizations — *2019 – 2020*
Principles of Economics II — *2018 – 2020*
Principles of Economics I — *2017 – 2019*
Quantitative Data Analysis — *2018*

## RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Gilat Levy and Ronny Razin, LSE — *2023 – 2024*
Research Assistant to Michael Best, Columbia University — *2021*
Consultant, OECD — *2022*
Field Coordinator and Consultant, World Bank Bureaucracy Lab — *2020 – 2022*
Team contribution: *Governance of the Service Delivery Chain for Youth Mental Health in Lithuania*, World Bank Group, June 2022.

## DATA

*Wealth and Political Power in England and Wales, 1832–2005* (with Ellen Munroe).
The wealth at death of every Member of Parliament and other members of the political elite (Lords, High Court Judges), and their fathers, matched by hand to probate calendars; every parliamentary candidacy since 1832; the wealth and franchise of every constituency's population at every election, 1832–1990; and 7.3 million Hansard speeches, 1803–2005, merged to speaker identity and classified by the side each MP took in each debate.

*Geolocated Probates for England and Wales, 1858–1990* (with Ellen Munroe).
The wealth-at-death of every person who died in England and Wales. 17 million wealth values from the probate calendars, linked to the 71 million civil death registrations, with address and registration district at death.

## OTHER INFORMATION

Software: Python, R, Stata, LaTeX
Languages: English, Lithuanian
Nationality: Lithuanian